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Amazon disputes report that it raised prices of popular items since Trump took office

A [report](#) in The Wall Street Journal (WSJ) last week found that prices on Amazon's low-cost essentials had risen since President Trump announced his plans for [massive tariffs](#) on international goods.

Amazon responded with a lengthy blog post in response to the article, which describes the WSJ's reporting as "[fundamentally flawed](#)."

WSJ analyzed the prices of 2,500 common Amazon items like cough drops, antibacterial wipes, and chicken broth, determining that the prices of these items increased on average by 10% from Trump's inauguration in January 2017 to July 2018.

IMAGE CREDITS:

Amazon accused WSJ of "cherry-picking" data and ignoring other factors surrounding the cost of certain products. According to Amazon, some of WSJ's findings were inaccurate because items like a Dove deodorant and a pack of Yogi Tea bags were on sale in January, when WSJ retrieved its initial pricing data. Amazon says that the price increase on these items occurred due to the promotion ending, not inflation or tariffs.

Amazon's pricing is often dynamic, leading to fluctuations, which is why a random sampling across products at a point in time makes sense for an analysis like this. That Amazon felt it had to respond to this report suggests the company is sensitive about the topic and could even fear retaliation from the Trump administration.

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Amazon costs aside, customers may observe slight upticks in costs on popular items. Per the [U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics' June report](#), consumer prices rose 0.3% on the month, or 2.7% on the year.

Topics: [Amazon](#) [Commerce](#) [inflation](#) [Tariffs](#) [WSJ](#)

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Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She...

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Amazon Prime Day to return in July despite threat of tariffs

Prime Day is here

Coming this July

Amazon is bringing back its annual sales event, Prime Day, in July, the e-commerce giant [said](#) on Tuesday.

This year, consumer demand for the popular sale event could be dampened by the possibility of tariffs increasing the cost of goods. To highlight the impact of President Trump's tariffs, Amazon will reportedly begin to display the cost of the tariffs next to the total price of goods on its site, according to [Punchbowl News](#).

The White House swiftly [blasted Amazon's decision](#) to display the impact of tariffs as "a hostile and political act by Amazon," White House press secretary Karoline Leavitt said in a press briefing on Tuesday morning.

IMAGE CREDITS: AMAZON

"This is another reason why Americans should buy American," she added.

Amazon quickly [responded, telling The Washington Post](#) (then [publishing the comment](#) on its blog) that listing import charges was something it had only considered for its low-cost Amazon Haul store, not the main site. (Reportedly, [Trump had called Amazon founder Jeff Bezos to complain.](#))

Amazon statement: "The team that runs our ultra low cost Amazon Haul store has considered listing import charges on certain products. This was never a consideration for the main Amazon site and nothing has been implemented on any Amazon properties."

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Prime Day is still months away, so it's unclear to

what extent tariffs could impact this year's sale

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That event also [saw more items sold](#) than any other Prime Day event to date, the retailer said.

This year, Amazon says, Prime Day will have deals across more than 35 categories, including electronics, kitchen, beauty, and apparel. Though the company is not teasing any deals yet, it did say that the sale will feature “socially trending items” as well as “creator favorites,” alongside other Amazon-exclusive products.

The event is also going to be held in Ireland this year for the first time and will return to a range of other global markets, including Australia, Austria, Belgium, Brazil, Canada, Egypt, France, Germany, India, Italy, Japan, Luxembourg, Mexico, the Netherlands, Poland, Portugal, Saudi Arabia, Singapore, Spain, Sweden, Turkey, the United Arab Emirates, the U.S., and the U.K.

Amazon on Tuesday also launched a new luxury goods selection on its site, curated by Saks.

This latest addition to Amazon’s Luxury Stores section will feature top brands like Dolce & Gabbana, Balmain, Etro, Stella McCartney, Giambattista Valli, Erdem, Fear of God, Jason Wu Collection, Rosetta Getty, Johanna Ortiz, Chantecaille, and La Prairie. U.S. customers will be able to shop the new collection on [amazon.com/saks](https://www.amazon.com/saks) and in the Amazon Shopping app.





Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [🦋](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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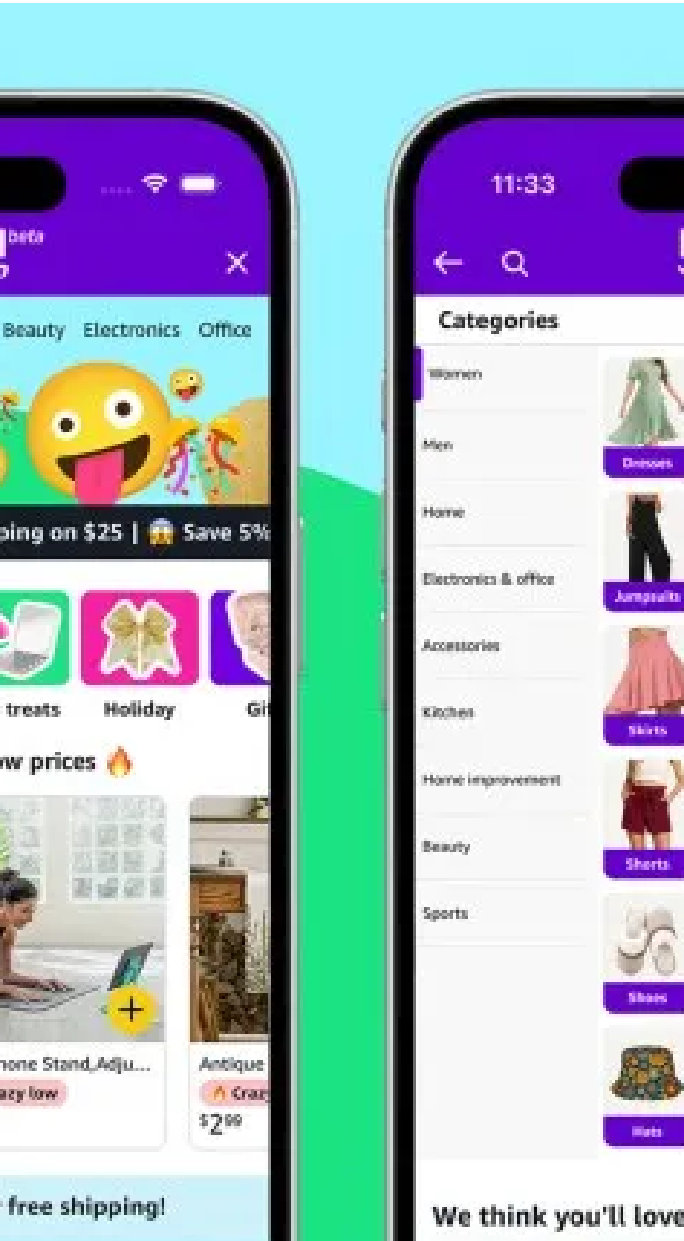


IMAGE CREDITS: AMAZON

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Amazon takes on Temu and Shein with discount ‘Amazon Haul’ store

Amanda Silberling — 8:02 AM PST · November 13, 2024

Amazon has [rolled out](#) its answer to the discounted, low-cost storefronts of Temu and Shein. The [Amazon Haul](#) store, currently available on the mobile app or mobile web browser exclusively, offers similar mass-produced, discounted items, most of which ship from China. It's a departure from Amazon's long-established reputation as a powerhouse of rapid delivery times since even Amazon can't reduce the time it takes to get these overseas goods.

The landing page for Amazon Haul is reminiscent of Shein and Temu even in its design: Items appear in grids, rather than Amazon's typical list, and shipping times and star ratings aren't visible unless you click on an item. Some items are labeled with rocket ship emojis that warn that this \$4.99 iPhone 16 Pro case is "selling fast!" Or, you might see a fire emoji declaring that the price for a three-pack of \$2.89 mesh laundry bags is "crazy low." Like its competitors, Amazon Haul also sells clothing (\$16 for a pair of men's golf pants, or \$4.99 for 80s-style women's leg warmers). In a "Staples" section, you can find an assortment of... sponges, resistance bands, hoodies, silicon baking mats, and socks.

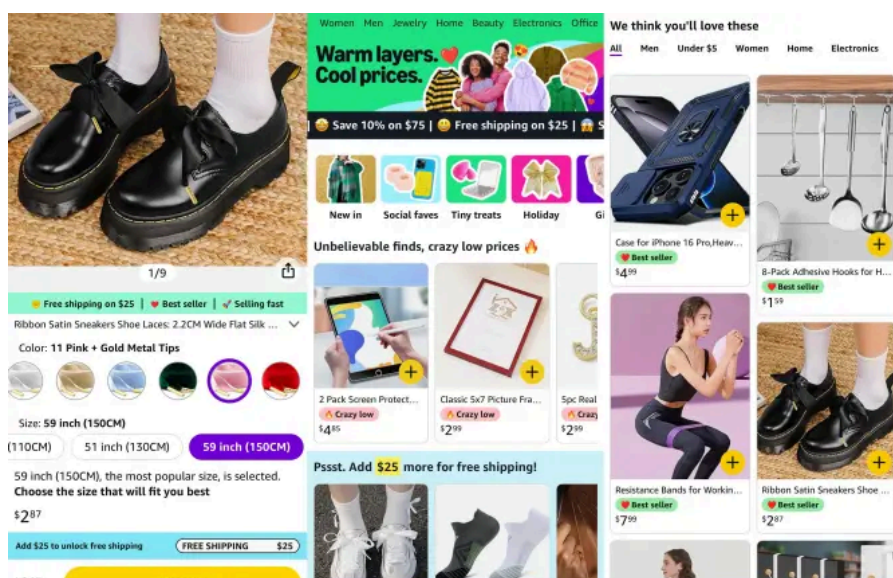


IMAGE CREDITS: AMAZON, SCREENSHOTS BY TECHCRUNCH

“While Amazon continues to offer over 300 million items with fast, free delivery for Prime members [...] we also hear from customers that sometimes they

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Sarah Perez - Jul 28, 2025

would love to shop ultra-low-priced products even if some of them take one to two weeks to arrive,” Amazon [wrote](#) in a blog post.

Temu and Shein have been subject to wide criticism over their [environmental impact](#), a byproduct of their worldwide shipping, and the waste caused by fast fashion. Both companies have also been subject to consumer protection probes in the European Union, where regulators are investigating their potential use of [addictive design patterns](#) and [illegal products](#).

Despite the controversy surrounding them, these low-cost retailers remain incredibly popular among Gen Z. According to research from app intelligence firm [Appfigures](#), the most popular app among U.S. users ages 18 to 24 was Temu, with almost 42 million downloads in that demographic between January and October 2024. For Shein, that estimate is about 14.7 million downloads, though it’s possible that the difference in download numbers is that stark because Gen Z users have already downloaded Shein, which has been around longer than Temu.

One risk for Shein and Temu is that consumers may not feel comfortable making purchases from unknown sellers that could potentially be misleading; consumers have more existing trust in Amazon, but the company is working with similar, largely China-based sellers of mass-produced goods. However, Amazon claims that it screens sellers ahead of time, and if customers want to return their purchase, they can do so for free within 15 days as long as the item is over \$3.

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It's a dubious time for Amazon to invest in this business model, given that president-elect Donald Trump has proposed leveraging a [60% tax](#) on imported Chinese goods. This tariff plan isn't set in stone, though — it's common for politicians to shift their campaign platforms after they've secured a win.

However, the popularity of Chinese e-commerce shipments has attracted bipartisan attention. The Biden administration has already [proposed congressional action](#) to crack down on what it calls "significant increased abuse" by Chinese e-commerce companies of the "de minimis" exception. The de minimis exemption allows shipments valued under \$800 to enter the U.S. duty free, which helps retailers like Temu and Shein maintain such low margins.

Topics: [Amazon](#) [Commerce](#) [Shein](#)





Amanda Silberling

Senior Writer | [X](#) [🦋](#) [in](#)

Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She...

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